

Value, Cost & Pricing Summary

1 The Value

BrandTrack 360 answers a question almost no organisation in Ghana or West Africa can currently answer: who is talking about us on radio, in the news, and on social, and is it moving toward us or away from us. Global monitoring tools (Meltwater, Brandwatch, Talkwalker) cover social media and online news well. None of them transcribe or monitor Ghanaian FM radio in Twi, Akan, or any local language, and radio is still the most trusted, most listened-to channel in the region. That gap is where reputational damage actually starts: a rumour, a grievance, a competitor jab, said on air, heard by thousands, and invisible to the comms team until it has already spread.

BrandTrack 360 closes it. Thirteen FM stations are transcribed automatically in real time, in English and Twi/Akan, alongside news and social. An AI Daily Brief narrates the previous 24 hours as audio a decision-maker can listen to on the morning commute, not a dashboard they have to remember to open. Alert rules catch a negative shift the moment it happens; an Incident War Room manages it if it becomes real; community geo-mapping and field observations connect what is said on air to what is happening on the ground. Every one of these features is built and running today, not on a roadmap.

The value is easiest to see against the cost of doing without it. A single CHRAJ petition or resettlement demand, the kind that follows a grievance nobody caught in time, costs a mining company far more than any annual licence. A comms team that already spends millions a year on community relations and CSR is not being asked to justify a new category of cost; it is being asked to spend a small fraction of a budget it already has, in a way that actually prevents the expensive version of the problem.

2 Cost to Build: \$45,000

This is a single, fixed figure for a Ghana-based development team, not a range: 2,250 development hours at a blended local rate of \$20/hour. It is a real replacement-cost estimate, itemised by what was actually built, not a rough guess.

What it covers	Hours	Cost
Core Intelligence (mentions, keywords, ingestion)	495	\$9,900
AI & Machine Learning (brief, NLP, transcription)	382	\$7,650
Analytics & Visualisation (dashboard, sentiment, graph)	338	\$6,750
Alerting & Notifications	225	\$4,500
Infrastructure & DevOps	202	\$4,050
Auth, Admin & Platform	180	\$3,600
Community & Field Operations	158	\$3,150
Reports & Export	158	\$3,150
UI Framework & Shared Components	112	\$2,250
Total	2,250	\$45,000

Running it costs far less than building it: roughly \$200 a month at early stage (hosting, transcription compute, LLM and TTS calls, storage, monitoring), rising to about \$1,030 a month at scale. That gap between build cost, run cost, and what the market will pay for the outcome is the entire basis for the pricing below.

3 Pricing, and Why It's Set There

Tier	Annual price	Monthly price	Onboarding	Keywords	Fits
Free/Demo	\$0, 30 days	\$0	—	2	Trial, lead generation
Starter	\$5,100	\$425	\$1,500	5	Single reporter or PR officer
Growth	\$15,000	\$1,250	\$3,000	15/project	Newsroom desk, mid-size operation
Institutional	\$42,500	\$3,542	\$10,000	Unlimited	Mining majors, Chamber of Mines, large corporates

The value metric is keywords tracked, and it is deliberate. It maps directly onto the actual cost driver, crawl volume, transcription minutes, and AI calls, so the price scales with what the platform is actually doing for that customer rather than with seat count. Everything else, export, benchmarking, real-time versus daily insight, gates on top of that rather than being sold piecemeal, which keeps the pricing simple to explain and to defend.

The tiers are anchored between two real markets, not invented from nothing. Below them: Brandwatch, Meltwater and Talkwalker run \$10,000 to \$15,000 a year and up, and none of them cover Ghanaian radio at all. Above them: Mention and Brand24 run \$588 to \$1,788 a year, and they only ever watch social media. BrandTrack 360's Starter tier, at \$5,100, sits between those two markets deliberately: cheaper than any enterprise tool with a fraction of its coverage, and more expensive than any budget tool because it does something budget tools structurally cannot, transcribe and monitor local-language radio.

The pricing pays back the build cost almost immediately. Nine Starter-tier clients, or three Growth-tier clients, or a single Institutional client, covers the entire \$45,000 build cost in year one. Year 1 alone is modelled at twelve clients and \$102,250 in revenue against \$7,200 in operating cost, more than double the cost of building the platform in its first year of commercial life. That is not an aggressive assumption; it is what twelve real, differently-sized clients on the tiers above actually add up to.

Institutional pricing reflects who is actually buying it. A mining major or a Chamber of Mines umbrella contract is not comparing \$42,500 a year to a monitoring budget line; it is comparing it to a single prevented incident, a CHRAJ petition, a resettlement demand, a regulatory escalation, any of which costs many multiples of a year's licence. Priced against the cost of the problem it prevents rather than against the cost of running a server, \$42,500 is inexpensive, not aggressive.

Figures are SIG's own fixed-point estimates from a September 2026 audit of the BrandTrack 360 / BrandwatchAfrica codebase and revenue model, not ranges. Prepared by Smart Innovations Ghana (SIG).